



THE FOOD DELIVERY WARS

AS ONLINE GROWTH SLOWS, COMPANIES IN THE BUSINESS ARE TARGETING VALUE-CONSCIOUS CONSUMERS, SIGNALLING A NEW PHASE OF COMPETITION AND INNOVATION IN A MARKET HIT BY HIGH PRICES AND LENGTHENING DELIVERY TIMES

BY **PALAK AGARWAL**

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It was a deal that made the market sit up and take notice. In September 2025, food delivery firm Swiggy sold its entire 12% stake in ride hailing start-up Rapido for almost ₹2,400 crore. The size of the deal turned heads, but to seasoned watchers of India's start-up ecosystem, the real story was in the timing.

Rapido had just launched Ownly, an affordable food delivery business, making it untenable for Swiggy to continue owning a significant stake in a direct competitor.